



# LOST BOYS CYBER

THREAT INTELLIGENCE • MALWARE ANALYSIS • DETECTION ENGINEERING



## CVE-2026-48939 iCagenda Unrestricted File Upload Active Exploitation

CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

|                       |                                                |
|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Classification</b> | TLP:CLEAR                                      |
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| <b>Author</b>         | Lost Boys Cyber                                |
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TLP:CLEAR | Lost Boys Cyber | CVE-2026-48939 iCagenda Unrestricted File Upload Active Exploitation - CVE / Vulnerability Threat Intelligence Report

Published: 2026-07-11 | TLP:CLEAR | Version: 1.0 | Author: Lost Boys Cyber

AI Generation: This report was generated with AI assistance and is provided for informational purposes only. All findings, IOCs, detection rules, hunting queries, attribution assessments, and recommendations must be independently reviewed and validated by a qualified security professional before operational use.

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# CVE-2026-48939 iCagenda Unrestricted File Upload Active Exploitation

## 1. Executive Summary

Lost Boys Cyber selected **CVE-2026-48939 iCagenda Unrestricted File Upload Active Exploitation** for the 2026-07-11 daily intelligence production run because CISA added **CVE-2026-48939** to the Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog on 2026-07-10 based on evidence of active exploitation. The vulnerability affects **iCagenda iCagenda** and is assessed as operationally urgent for internet-facing CMS operators because the public KEV description maps to arbitrary upload of executable content and potential PHP code execution.

This report prioritizes practical defensive action over exploit reproduction. Organizations should identify exposed iCagenda deployments, apply vendor remediation or remove the component where patching is not immediately possible, review web roots for recently written PHP or archive files, and hunt for suspicious upload-to-execution chains.

## 2. Vulnerability Metadata

| Field                  | Value                                                                    |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CVE                    | CVE-2026-48939                                                           |
| Vendor / Product       | iCagenda / iCagenda                                                      |
| Weakness               | CWE-434 unrestricted upload of file with dangerous type                  |
| CISA KEV Status        | Added 2026-07-10; active exploitation reported by CISA                   |
| Ransomware Association | CISA KEV lists ransomware use as unknown at publication time             |
| Exploitation Theme     | Web upload handler abuse leading to executable PHP content on the server |
| Priority               | High for internet-facing or externally reachable CMS deployments         |

## 3. Source Review & Confidence

| Source                    | URL                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Analyst Use                                                                   |
|---------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CISA 2026-07-10 KEV alert | <a href="https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2026/07/10/cisa-adds-two-known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog">https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2026/07/10/cisa-adds-two-known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog</a> | Primary source for active exploitation and defender urgency.                  |
| CISA KEV catalog          | <a href="https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog">https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog</a>                                                                                         | Canonical vulnerability description, weakness, and remediation-action source. |
| NVD CVE record            | <a href="https://nvd.nist.gov/vuln/detail/CVE-2026-48939">https://nvd.nist.gov/vuln/detail/CVE-2026-48939</a>                                                                                                                   | Vulnerability identifier reference and future CVSS/CPE enrichment point.      |

Source depth is sufficient for a focused vulnerability-threat report because CISA provides the exploitation basis and canonical KEV description. Where vendor exploit details or IOCs are not public, this report labels detection logic as behavioral and prioritizes exposure management.

## 4. Vulnerability Details

CVE-2026-48939 is described by CISA as unrestricted upload of file with dangerous type vulnerability in the file attachment feature; public KEV text states arbitrary PHP upload and execution is possible. The most important defensive implication is that a public content-management extension upload flow may become a remote code execution path when uploaded content is placed somewhere the web server can execute it.

| Technical Element       | Defender Interpretation                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| File upload control     | Review extension-specific upload endpoints, accepted MIME types, and server-side validation.                                 |
| Executable content risk | Treat unexpected `.php`, `.phtml`, `.phar`, archive, or polyglot files in upload paths as high-priority evidence.            |
| Web-server execution    | Confirm upload directories are configured non-executable and that PHP handlers are disabled where possible.                  |
| Authentication context  | CISA text should drive triage priority; if unauthenticated exposure is possible, prioritize internet-facing instances first. |

## 5. Attack Scenarios

| Scenario                | Attack Path                                                                                   | Expected Evidence                                                                                         |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Web shell placement     | Attacker uploads a PHP payload through the vulnerable component, then invokes it over HTTP.   | New script in upload/plugin path, HTTP POST/GET to the uploaded path, unusual web-server child processes. |
| Staging and persistence | Attacker uses the web shell to stage tools, credential files, or additional payloads.         | Archive creation, outbound curl/wget, new cron/web config changes, credential-file reads.                 |
| Shared-hosting pivot    | Compromise of one CMS tenant exposes credentials or writable paths for adjacent applications. | Cross-site file access, new database users, changes to shared config files.                               |

## 6. Threat Landscape & Exploitation Status

CISA KEV inclusion is enough to treat this as exploited in the wild. Lost Boys Cyber did not identify a reliable public IOC set for this report at generation time, so defenders should combine asset discovery, web-server log review, EDR process telemetry, and file-integrity monitoring rather than waiting for atomic indicators.

## 7. Affected Products and Exposure

| Exposure Area                                                                                                                         | Why It Matters                                                                    | Immediate Check                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Joomla extension upload workflow, public CMS administration surfaces, hosting accounts, and web roots where PHP execution is enabled. | These surfaces can turn arbitrary upload into code execution or durable foothold. | Enumerate deployments, versions, public routes, and upload directories.              |
| Web server and PHP runtime                                                                                                            | Executable handlers determine whether uploaded content becomes code.              | Disable script execution in upload directories and review handler mappings.          |
| CMS administrator accounts                                                                                                            | Post-exploitation often creates or abuses privileged users.                       | Review new admin users, password resets, plugin installs, and configuration changes. |

## 8. Mitigation and Workarounds

| Priority | Action                                                                     | Owner              |
|----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| P0       | Patch or disable the vulnerable extension/component on all internet-facing | Web platform owner |

|    |                                                                                    |                       |
|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
|    | systems.                                                                           |                       |
| P0 | Block external access to upload routes until remediated if patching is delayed.    | Network / WAF team    |
| P1 | Remove executable permissions and PHP handlers from upload directories.            | Web / hosting team    |
| P1 | Review web roots for suspicious recent files and preserve evidence before cleanup. | SOC / IR              |
| P2 | Add file-integrity and web-server process monitoring for CMS hosts.                | Detection engineering |

## 9. Detection Engineering

### 9.1. Detection Logic Summary

| Signal                                                                            | Telemetry Source       | Analytic Goal                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| New PHP-like files in upload, media, cache, or extension directories              | FIM / EDR / web server | Detect web shell placement.             |
| Web-server parent spawning shell, scripting, archiving, or network-transfer tools | EDR process telemetry  | Detect web shell execution and staging. |
| HTTP requests to newly created upload paths followed by command execution         | Web logs + EDR         | Correlate upload-to-execution chain.    |

```

title: Lost Boys Cyber - CVE-2026-48939 Suspicious CMS Upload To Execution
id: lbc-vti-2026-115-cms-upload-execution
status: experimental
description: Detects web-server spawned command execution that can follow exploitation of CVE-2026-48939 style unrestricted upload flaws.
logsource:
  product: windows
  category: process_creation
detection:
  web_parent:
    ParentImage|contains:
      - '\apache'
      - '\httpd'
      - '\nginx'
      - '\php-cgi'
      - '\w3wp.exe'
  suspicious_child:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '\certutil.exe'
      - '\curl.exe'
      - '\wget.exe'
      - '\bitsadmin.exe'
      - '\tar.exe'
      - '\7z.exe'
  condition: web_parent and suspicious_child
fields:
  - UtcTime
  - Computer
  - ParentImage
  - Image

```

```

- CommandLine
- User
falsepositives:
- Rare administrative maintenance scripts on web servers
level: high

```

## 10. Threat Hunting

```

DeviceFileEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where FolderPath has_any ("/upload", "/uploads", "/media", "/cache", "/tmp", "\uploads", "\media")
| where FileName endswith_any (".php", ".phtml", ".phar", ".jsp", ".aspx")
| summarize FirstSeen=min(Timestamp), LastSeen=max(Timestamp), Paths=make_set(FolderPath, 20) by
DeviceName, FileName, InitiatingProcessAccountName
| order by LastSeen desc

DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("apache.exe", "httpd.exe", "nginx.exe", "php-cgi.exe",
"w3wp.exe")
| where FileName in~ ("cmd.exe", "powershell.exe", "sh", "bash", "curl.exe", "wget.exe", "python.exe",
"perl.exe", "tar.exe", "7z.exe")
| project Timestamp, DeviceName, InitiatingProcessFileName, FileName, ProcessCommandLine, AccountName
| order by Timestamp desc

index=* (sourcetype=access_combined OR sourcetype=apache:access OR sourcetype=nginx:plus:kv)
(uri_path="*upload*" OR uri_path="*media*" OR uri_path="*cache*") (uri_path="*.php" OR
uri_path="*.phtml" OR uri_path="*.phar")
| stats min(_time) as first_seen max(_time) as last_seen count by src_ip host uri_path status
user_agent

```

## 11. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

| Technique | Name                                 | Rationale                                                    |
|-----------|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| T1190     | Exploit Public-Facing Application    | Exploitation targets an exposed CMS component.               |
| T1505.003 | Server Software Component: Web Shell | Arbitrary PHP upload can create a web shell condition.       |
| T1059     | Command and Scripting Interpreter    | Post-exploitation commonly invokes shell or scripting tools. |
| T1105     | Ingress Tool Transfer                | Web shells are frequently used to pull additional tooling.   |

## 12. Validation / Lab Testing

Lost Boys Cyber did not reproduce exploitation or publish exploit steps. Recommended validation is defensive: confirm the asset inventory can find iCagenda, confirm upload directories are non-executable, and run benign detection simulations for web-server spawned shell commands in an isolated test environment.

## 13. Recommended Actions Summary

| Timeframe | Action                                                                                              |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Today     | Patch/disable exposed iCagenda deployments and search upload paths for suspicious executable files. |
| 48 hours  | Review web logs for upload-to-execution patterns and add the included KQL/Sigma/SPL to hunt queues. |

|        |                                                                                                                    |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7 days | Harden CMS upload directories, validate backups, and confirm WAF or reverse-proxy controls cover upload endpoints. |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## 14. References

- [1] CISA alert, 2026-07-10: <https://www.cisa.gov/news-events/alerts/2026/07/10/cisa-adds-two-known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog>
- [2] CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog: <https://www.cisa.gov/known-exploited-vulnerabilities-catalog>
- [3] NVD record for CVE-2026-48939: <https://nvd.nist.gov/vuln/detail/CVE-2026-48939>